HETHERSGILL PARISH & SURROUNDING AREAS

COMMUNITY UPDATE

NATIONAL GRID CROSS BORDER CONNECTION

HETHERSGILL PARISH HALL | 20 OCTOBER 2026 | 19:00

ALL COMMUNITIES ACROSS NORTH CARLISLE/CUMBRIA WELCOME!

WORKING TOGETHER

RAISING OUR VOICES

PROTECTING OUR COMMUNITIES

BUILDING A STRONG LOCAL RESPONSE

NORTH CARLISLE/CUMBRIA AGAINST PYLONS & SUBSTATIONS

NORTH CARLISLE/CUMBRIA AGAINST PYLONS AND SUBSTATION

FROM COMMUNITY CAMPAIGN TO A FORMAL, INDEPENDENT VOICE

WHO WE ARE

Created in October 2025 in response to National Grid's Stage 1 consultation.

A collective of Parish Council members, concerned residents and skilled volunteers.

Now formally incorporated to strengthen governance, representation and action.

WHAT WE DO

EVIDENCE & SCRUTINY
Assess the scheme, alternatives and cumulative impacts.

COMMUNITY INFORMATION
Share clear information and build an informed local response.

INFLUENCE & ENGAGEMENT
Engage councils, elected leaders, statutory bodies, NESO and National Grid.

NSIP PREPARATION
Build the evidence, expertise and organisation needed for the DCO process.

NOW FORMALLY INCORPORATED

COMPANY LIMITED BY GUARANTEE

- 4 Members
- 4 Directors
- Maximum 7 board places
- Articles of Association adopted
- Purpose and governance formally set out
- Independent legal structure to support coordinated action
- Raise funding to participate in the DCO / Examination

OUR JOURNEY TO THIS POINT

1. October 2025 — Community campaign formed
2. Build local evidence and awareness
3. Develop alliances and coordinated response
4. Incorporate as a Company Limited by Guarantee



COMMUNITY LED • EVIDENCE BASED • FORMALLY ORGANISED • READY TO ACT

WORKING TOGETHER

NG CBC indicative stakeholder relationships

Voluntary collaboration • Shared concerns

AUTONOMOUS COMMUNITY CAMPAIGN

NCAPS Community Action Limited

Company limited by guarantee, with its own governance, decisions and funds.

Undertakes campaign activity and works alongside communities to exchange information and raise awareness.

AUTONOMOUS LOCAL COUNCILS

Individual Parish Councils

Each North Cumbrian Council.

Each Council has its own democratic accountability, decisions, budget and local priorities.

Each can make its own representations and raise parish-specific concerns.

Community collaboration

Partnership

Council collaboration

INDEPENDENT COMMUNITY VOICES

Community Participation

Residents, volunteers, local groups and other participants.

People and groups choose how to engage, contribute and express their own views.

Participation is voluntary. Individuals and groups retain their own identity and independence.

SHARED PARISH COUNCIL FORUM

Parish Council Alliance

North Cumbria Parish Council Alliance.

Councils work together on an agreed position through a Memorandum of Understanding.

A forum for exchanging evidence, agreeing joint representations and collaborating with relevant partners.

COLLABORATION

Each organisation, individual and group decides its own position and level of involvement.
Joint statements and actions require agreement from those represented.
Collaboration creates no authority over other participants.

WHO IS NATIONAL GRID — AND WHO PAYS?

The organisations behind the Cross Border Connection

NATIONAL GRID plc

Publicly listed, investor owned energy infrastructure group.

NATIONAL GRID ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION (NGET)

Owns, develops and maintains the high voltage transmission network in England and Wales.

PROJECT PROMOTER AND ASSET OWNER

DESNZ

Department for Energy Security and Net Zero

Sets national energy policy and legislation.

The Secretary of State makes the final DCO decision.

POLICY & LAW

NESO

National Energy System Operator

- Publicly owned and independent of National Grid.
- Plans the energy system and identifies network need.
- Does not own the pylons or substations.

OFGEM

Independent energy regulator

- Licences NGET and NESO.
- Sets price controls and allowed revenue.
- Tests costs and protects consumers.

SYSTEM NEED & PLAN

LICENCE, FUNDING & PRICE CONTROL

NGET

National Grid Electricity Transmission

Designs the project, consults, seeks consent, raises finance, builds and owns the assets.

DCO APPLICATION

SECRETARY OF STATE

Makes the final Development Consent Order (DCO) decision.

HOW THE MONEY FLOWS

1. **RAISES CAPITAL** — Debt + shareholder equity
2. **BUILDS THE ASSETS** — Pylons, lines and substations
3. **OFGEM SETS ALLOWED REVENUE** — Efficient costs + financing + regulated return
4. **NETWORK CHARGES** — Paid through the electricity system
5. **CONSUMER BILLS** — Network costs ultimately form part of electricity prices

NESO PLANS THE NEED • NGET BUILDS AND OWNS • OFGEM CONTROLS REVENUE • DESNZ SETS POLICY

RIIO T3 price control: April 2026 to March 2031. Ofgem does not grant planning consent. NESO is not part of National Grid.

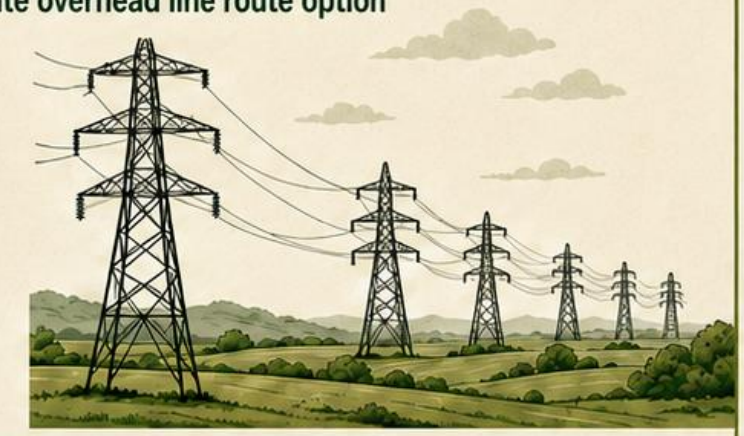
CROSS BORDER CONNECTION: SIZE, COST & SCALE

PYLON ROUTE

28 km

Approximate overhead line route option

- 17.4 miles
- Steel lattice pylons
- Up to c.50 m tall



0 — 28 km

OPTION A SUBSTATION

30 hectares / 74 acres

Approximate site area

- Around 42 football pitches
- Industrial-scale electricity substation
- Structures up to around 3 storeys high



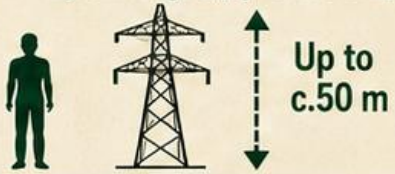
INDICATIVE COST

£200m – £400m

Consultation-stage estimate for a route option

LIKELY COST: £500m – £600m

Pylon height (up to c.50 m)



Site scale (around 42 football pitches)



≈ 42 football pitches

Route length

0 — 28 km

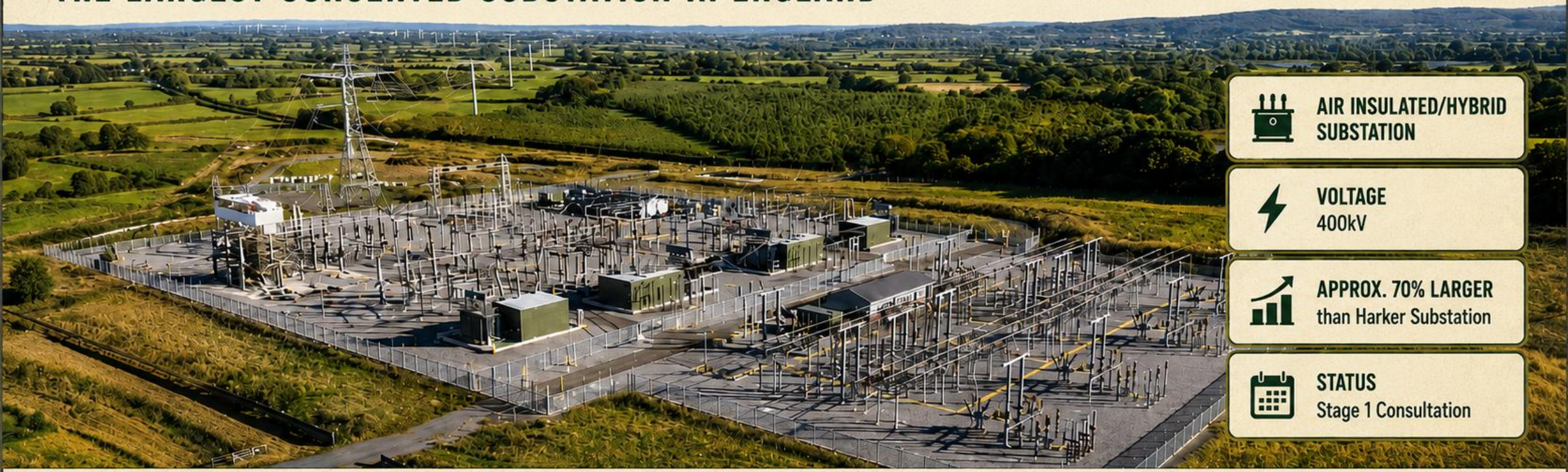
NATIONAL GRID CROSS BORDER CONNECTION

OPTION A SUBSTATION

THE LARGEST CONSENTED SUBSTATION IN ENGLAND

SITE AREA
Approx. 74 acres

BUILDING HEIGHT
Up to 18 metres



AIR INSULATED/HYBRID SUBSTATION

VOLTAGE
400kV

APPROX. 70% LARGER
than Harker Substation

STATUS
Stage 1 Consultation

NCAPS

North Carlisle/Cumbria
Against Pylons and Substation

This is not progress for North Carlisle/Cumbria.
There is a better alternative at Option B.

OUR LANDSCAPE.
OUR COMMUNITY.
OUR FUTURE.

SAY NO TO OPTION A

HOW THE NSIP PLANNING PROCESS WORKS

Who develops, examines and decides — and where communities can participate

1 PRE-APPLICATION

STILL REQUIRED

National Grid prepares the scheme, environmental evidence and DCO application.

MAY 2027
STAGE 2 OPTIONS CONSULTATION
National Grid commitment
Not a statutory gateway

The key opportunity to challenge Option A before submission.

2 ACCEPTANCE

MANDATORY • UP TO 28 DAYS

The Planning Inspectorate must decide whether the application is suitable to proceed.

Cannot advance to pre-examination unless accepted.

3 PRE-EXAMINATION

Register as an Interested Party.

Submit a Relevant Representation and identify the issues that matter.

4 EXAMINATION

UP TO 6 MONTHS

Written questions, evidence, hearings and site visits.

Local authorities may submit Local Impact Reports.

5 RECOMMENDATION

UP TO 3 MONTHS

The Examining Authority reports and recommends an outcome.

6 DECISION

UP TO 3 MONTHS

The Secretary of State grants or refuses the Development Consent Order.

WHO DOES WHAT?

NATIONAL GRID
Develops and submits the application.

PLANNING INSPECTORATE
Accepts, examines and recommends.

SECRETARY OF STATE
Makes the final DCO decision.

COMMUNITIES & COUNCILS
Register, submit evidence and participate.

AFTER THE DECISION — A legal challenge tests whether the decision was lawful — it does not reopen the planning merits.

THE MAY 2027 CONSULTATION IS NOT A LEGAL GATEWAY • PREPARATION AND ACCEPTANCE REMAIN REQUIRED

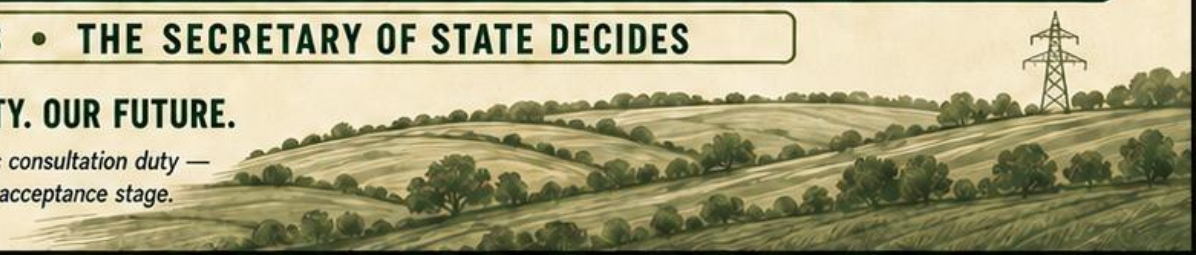
THE PLANNING INSPECTORATE EXAMINES • THE SECRETARY OF STATE DECIDES

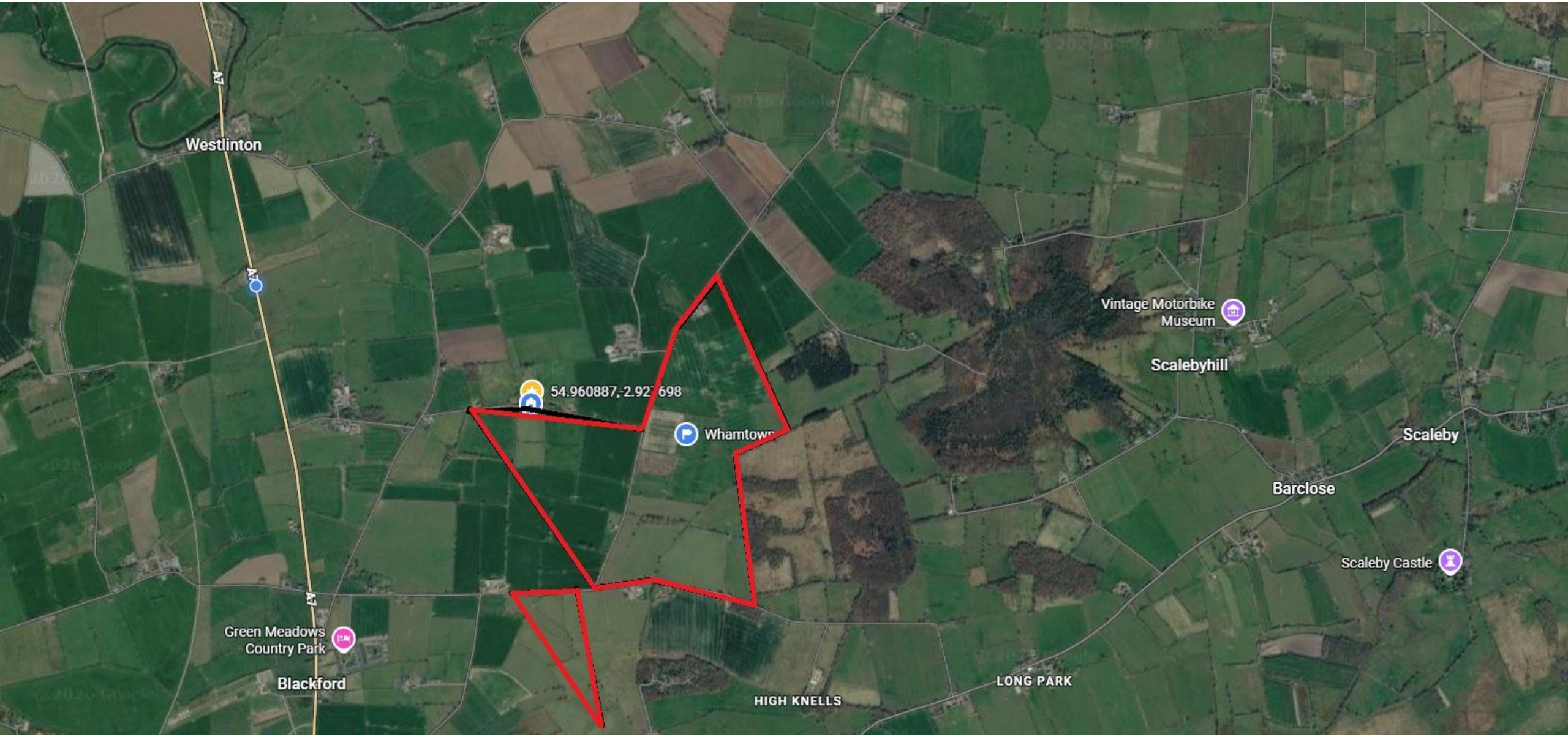
NCAPS

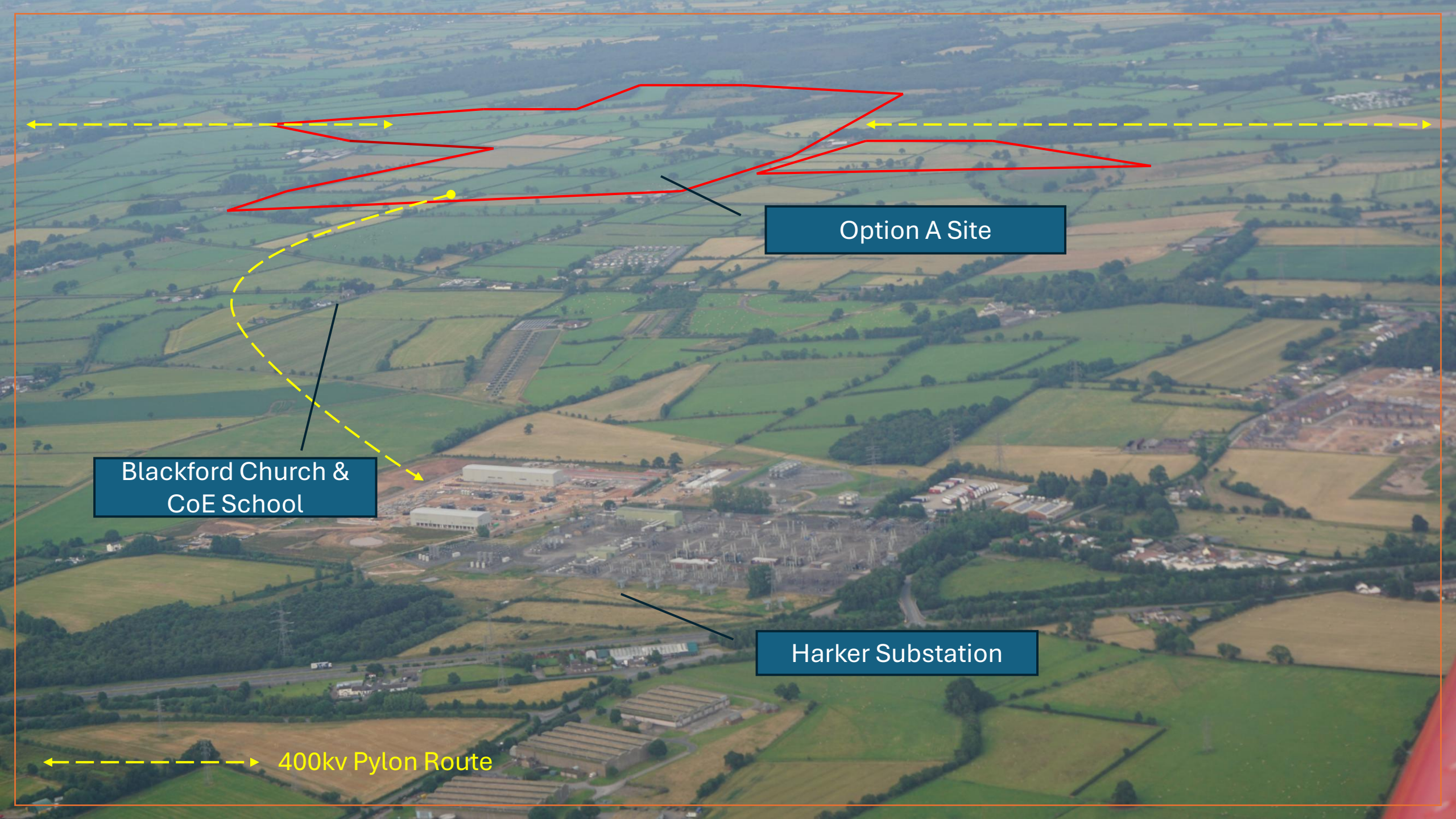
North Carlisle/Cumbria Against Pylons and Substation

OUR LANDSCAPE. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE.

July 2026 reforms removed the prescribed public consultation duty — not pre-application preparation or the mandatory acceptance stage.




Westlinton
A7
A7
A7
54.960887,-2.927698
Whamtown
Vintage Motorbike Museum
Scalebyhill
Scaleby
Barclose
Scaleby Castle
Green Meadows Country Park
Blackford
HIGH KNELLS
LONG PARK


Option A Site
Blackford Church & CoE School
Harker Substation
400kv Pylon Route


Scaleby Moss
Option A Site


HARKER SUBSTATION £252M UPGRADE – COMPLETION 2027!
M6 Motorway



Option A – 15x Larger than 400kV Sandford substation

OPTION A: BIGGER THAN TALKIN TARN

A local landmark comparison



THE OPTION A FOOTPRINT WOULD COVER TALKIN TARN — AND EXTEND BEYOND IT

North Carlisle/Cumbria
Against Pylons and Substation

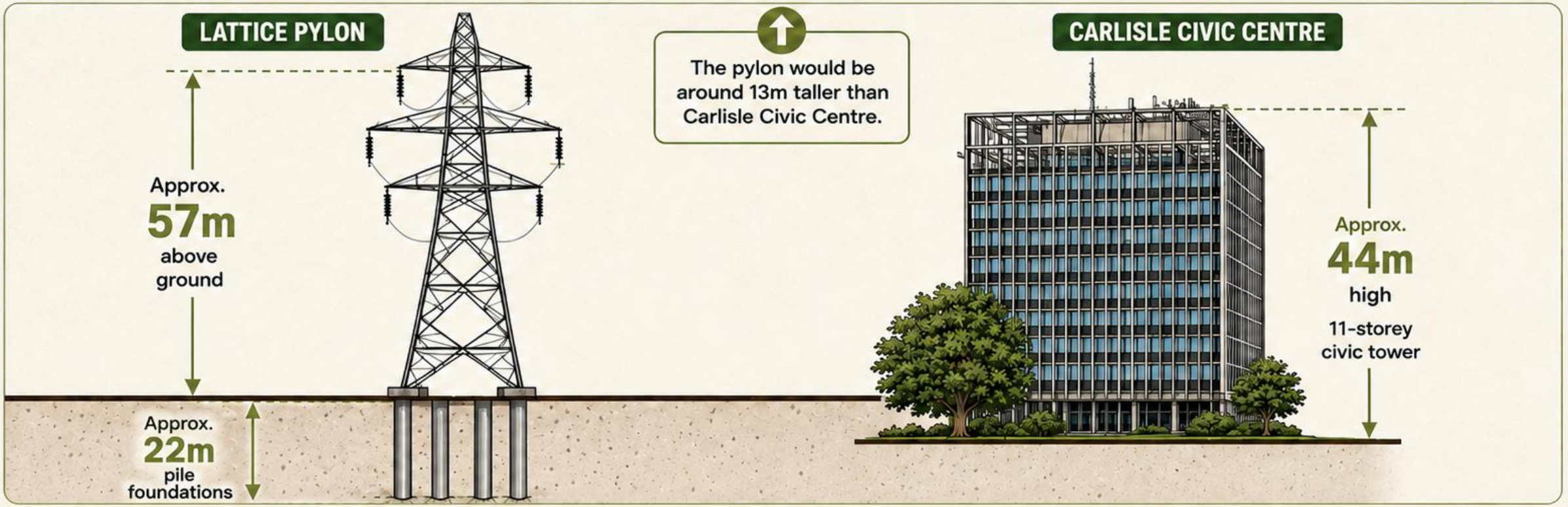
OUR LANDSCAPE. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE.

Indicative area comparison only.
Not a proposed location or surveyed site plan.
Figures are approximate.

57m LATTICE PYLON vs CARLISLE CIVIC CENTRE

A simple scale comparison of the proposed infrastructure

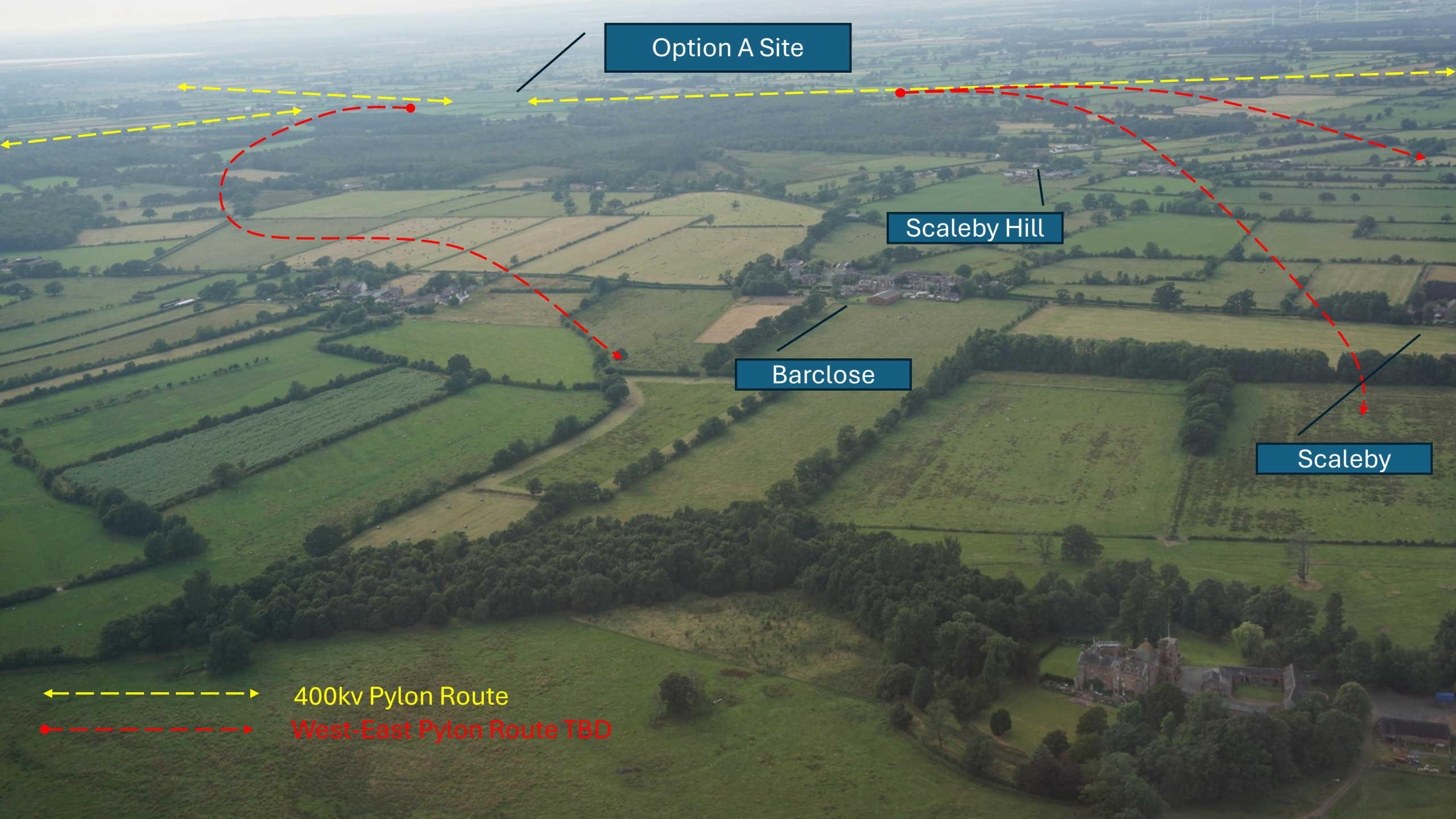
A 57m pylon would stand around 13m taller than Carlisle Civic Centre.



Pylon height:	Civic Centre height:	Difference above ground:	Pile foundations:
c.57m	c.44m	c.13m	c.22m below ground

Figures are indicative and intended to show scale.

Carlisle Civic Centre tower height is approximate and measured to the top of the roof structure.
Pylon height and foundation depth are approximate and based on typical specifications.


Option A Site
Scaleby Hill
Barclose
Scaleby
400kv Pylon Route
West-East Pylon Route TBD

NORTH CUMBRIA – PLUGGING THE GAP



THE CROSS BORDER CONNECTION IS ONLY ONE PART OF A MUCH WIDER ELECTRICITY-NETWORK PLAN.

THE FORECAST GAP

By 2035, the network is expected to face a shortfall of:

10.4–11.6 GW

across the B6 boundary

ONE NEW ROUTE

One double-circuit 400 kV line can carry no more than:

6.9 GW

ONE ROUTE CANNOT CLOSE THE GAP

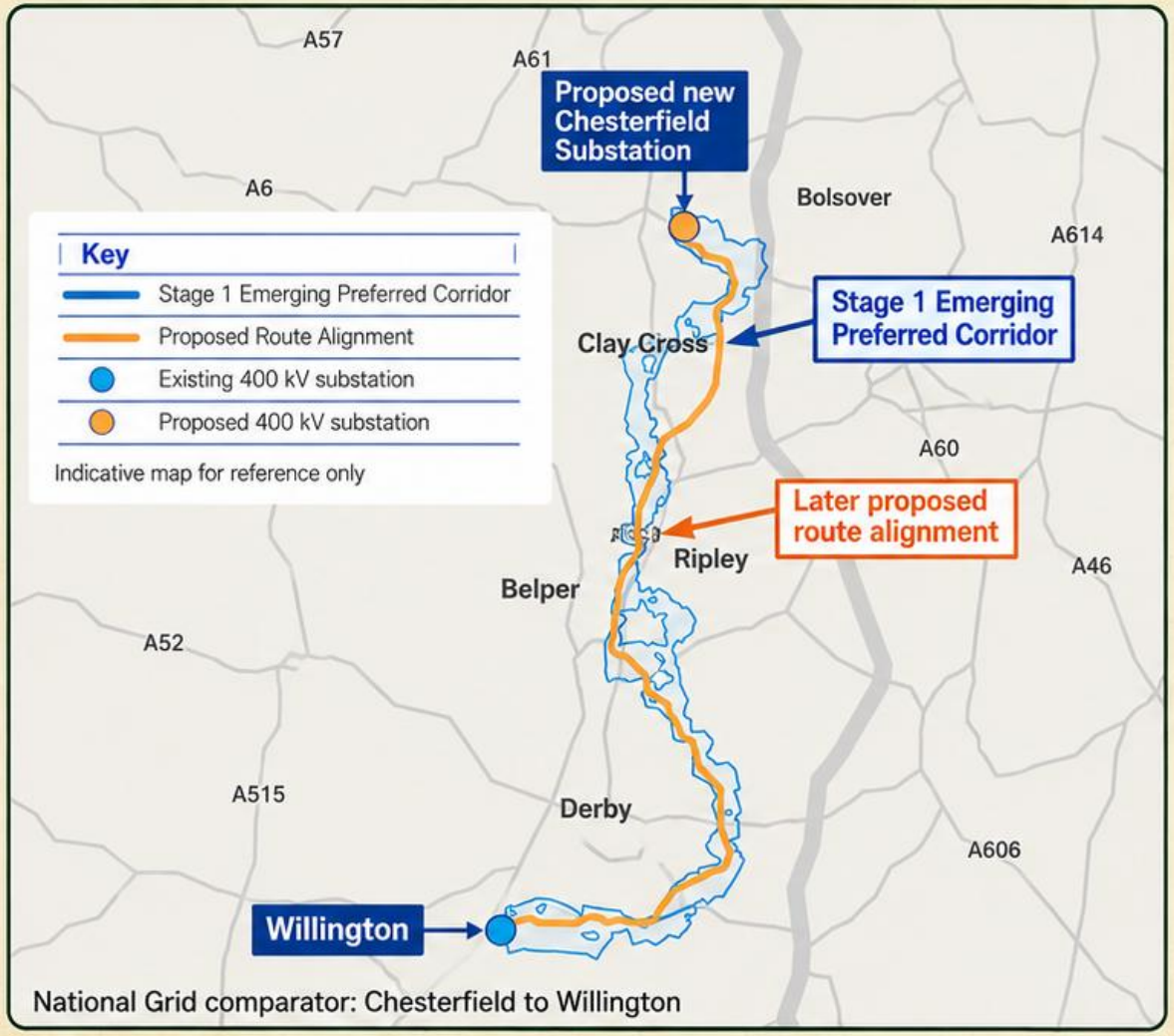
THE WIDER PLAN

- **FSU1 – HARKER TO STELLA WEST** reinforcement
- **CLN2 – NEW CIRCUIT ACROSS** North West England
- **WCN2 – NEW CIRCUIT BETWEEN** South West Scotland and North West England

CARLISLE IS INTENDED TO CONNECT CBC, FSU1 AND CLN2

STAGE 1 CORRIDOR ≠ FIXED ROUTE

National Grid can refine and deviate from an emerging preferred corridor where design and evidence require



WHAT THIS SHOWS

1 STAGE 1 IS A CORRIDOR, NOT A FINAL ROUTE

The consultation corridor guides option development but does not freeze the eventual alignment.

2 THE ROUTE CAN MOVE WHERE REQUIRED

Design development, environmental evidence, engineering constraints and consultation feedback can lead to departures from the original corridor.

3 STAGE 2 CAN LOOK MATERIALLY DIFFERENT

The more developed route presented later may extend beyond parts of the Stage 1 preferred corridor.

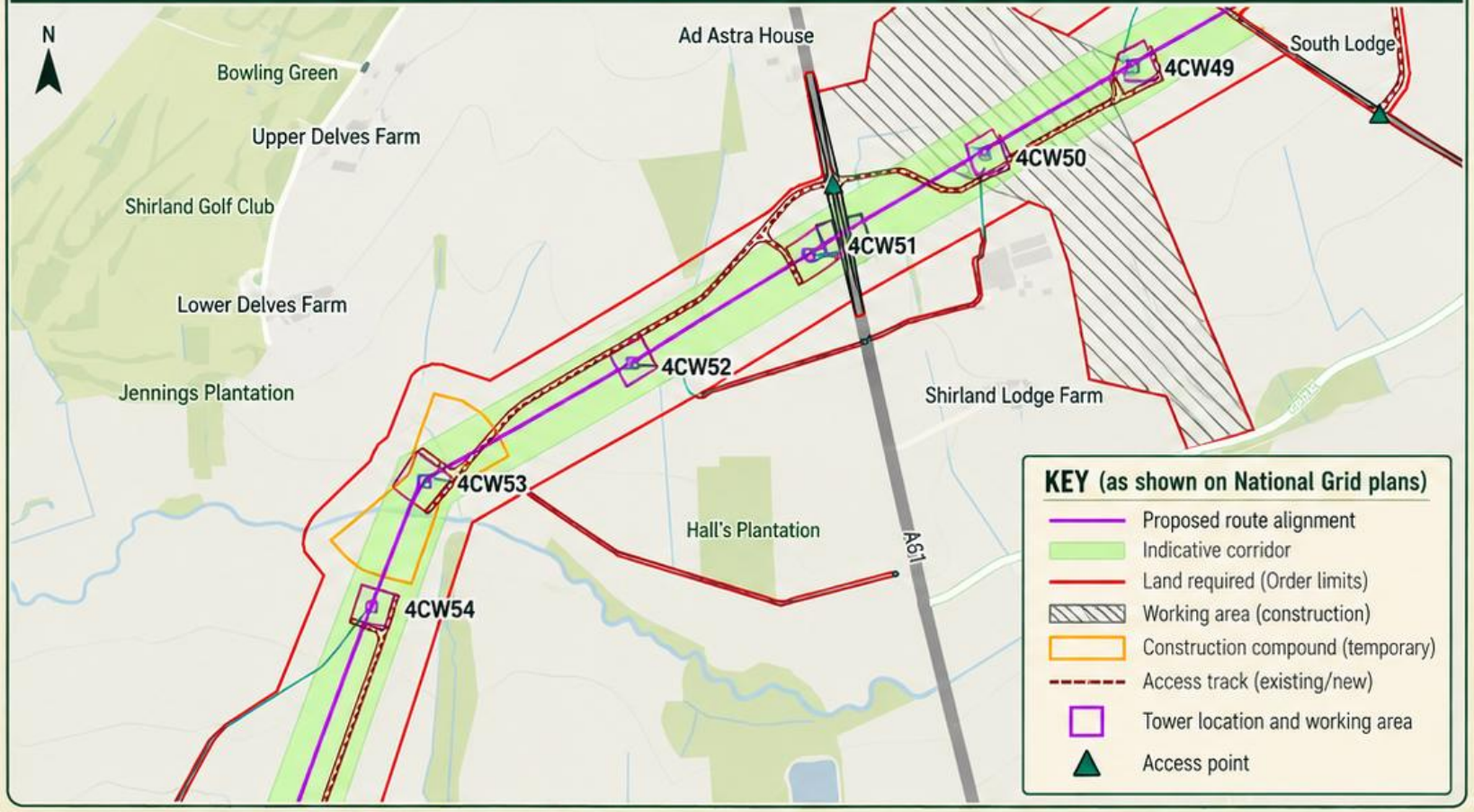
THE STAGE 1 CBC CORRIDOR SHOULD NOT BE TREATED AS AN IMMUTABLE BOUNDARY

FOR CROSS BORDER CONNECTION: ROUTE REFINEMENT REMAINS POSSIBLE BEFORE STAGE 2 – INCLUDING MOVEMENT AWAY FROM MORE HARMFUL ALIGNMENTS

LEVEL OF DETAIL COMMUNITIES WILL SEE IN MAY 2027

FROM BROAD CORRIDORS TO DETAILED PLANS FOR LAND, ACCESS AND CONSTRUCTION

EXAMPLE: DETAILED MAP SECTION FROM THE CBC PROPOSALS



WHAT THE DETAILED MAPS SHOW

EXACT ROUTE ALIGNMENT
Refined from the Stage 1 corridor to a detailed centre line.

TOWER LOCATIONS
Individual tower positions with construction working areas (e.g. 4CW49–4CW54).

CONSTRUCTION WORKING AREAS
Large temporary working areas around each tower (typically 40m × 40m or more) and for site access.

ACCESS ROUTES
New and upgraded access tracks for construction traffic, machinery and materials.

LAND TAKE
The red line shows the land required for the Development Consent Order (DCO), including temporary and permanent rights.

THIS IS THE LEVEL OF DETAIL THE COMMUNITY WILL SEE AT STAGE 2 CONSULTATION IN MAY 2027
The consultation will include detailed maps showing the refined route alignment, land requirements, working areas, access arrangements and construction compounds for the CBC proposals.

OUR LANDSCAPE. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE.

THE BIGGER PICTURE

THE CROSS BORDER CONNECTION

OPTIONS A & B ARE JUST THE FIRST PHASE

PART OF A WIDER REINFORCEMENT PROGRAMME
Options A & B sit within a larger strategic reinforcement programme for the North West, as set out in NESO Beyond 2030.

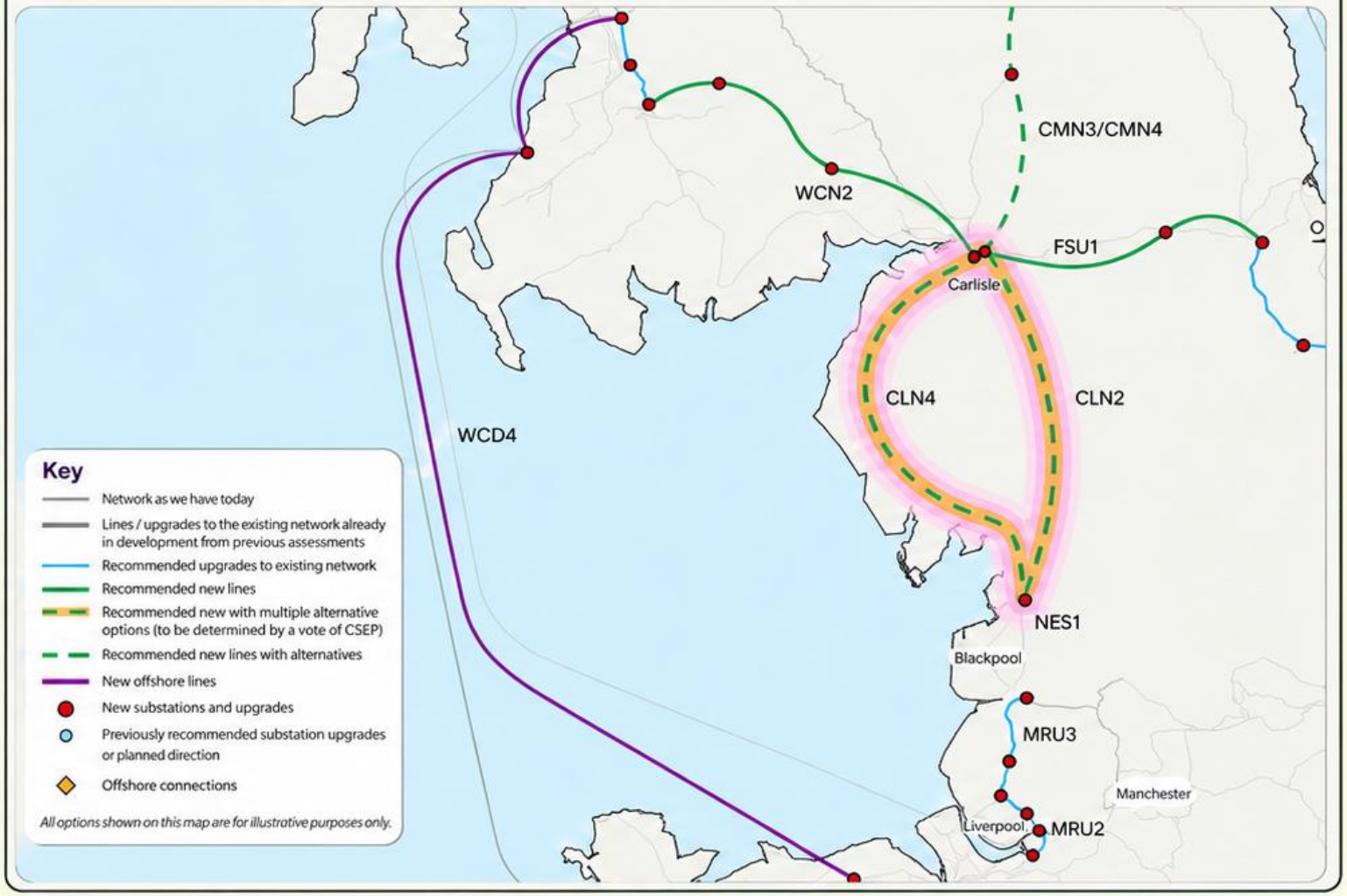
ADDITIONAL 400 kV REINFORCEMENTS BEYOND CBC
NESO's plans indicate further 400 kV reinforcements across the North West beyond the Cross Border Connection Options A & B.

CARLISLE – NEWCASTLE REINFORCEMENT EXPECTED LATER
A separate scheme is expected after CBC, with further pylons and substations across our area (Carlisle – Newcastle line).

CONSIDER THE BIGGER, LONG-TERM IMPACTS
Communities must look beyond Options A & B and consider the cumulative and long-term impacts on our landscape, environment and way of life.

NESO BEYOND 2030 SHOWS CBC OPTIONS A & B AS PART OF A BROADER NORTH WEST REINFORCEMENT PICTURE.

Figure 16: Map of the recommended network for North West

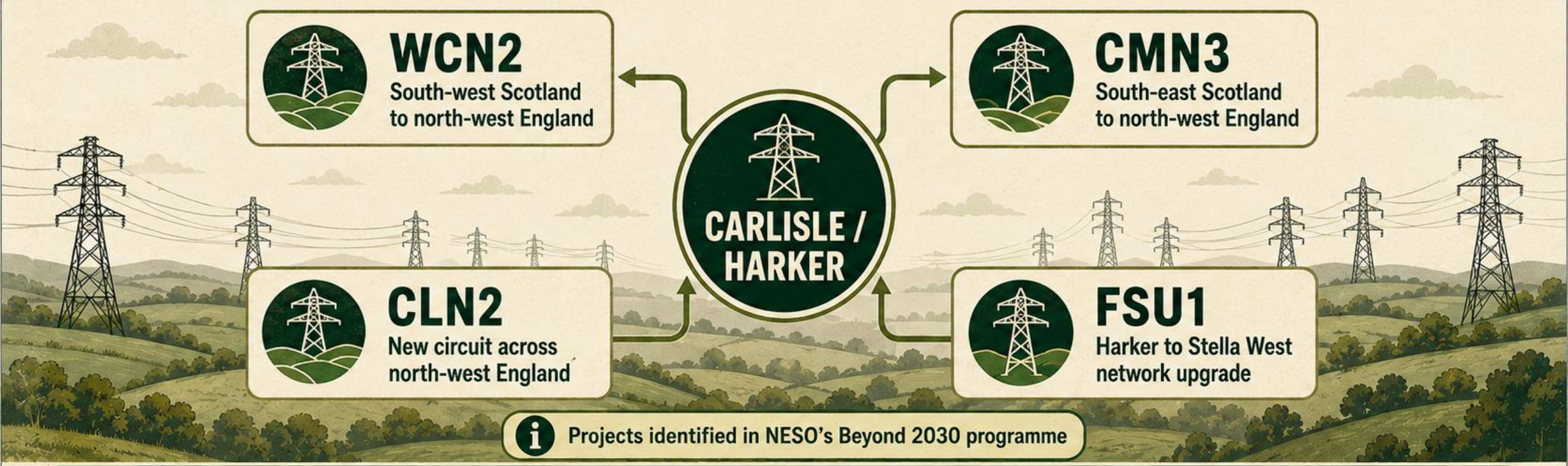


WORKING TOGETHER | RAISING OUR VOICES | PROTECTING OUR COMMUNITIES | OUR LANDSCAPE, OUR COMMUNITT, OUR FUTURE.

NORTH CARLISLE/CUMBRIA AGAINST PYLONS & SUBSTATION

MULTIPLE PYLON PROJECTS ON THE WAY!

NESO's Beyond 2030 planning points to a pipeline of major transmission schemes affecting Cumbria and the wider North.



THE PROSPECT: YEARS OF DISRUPTION

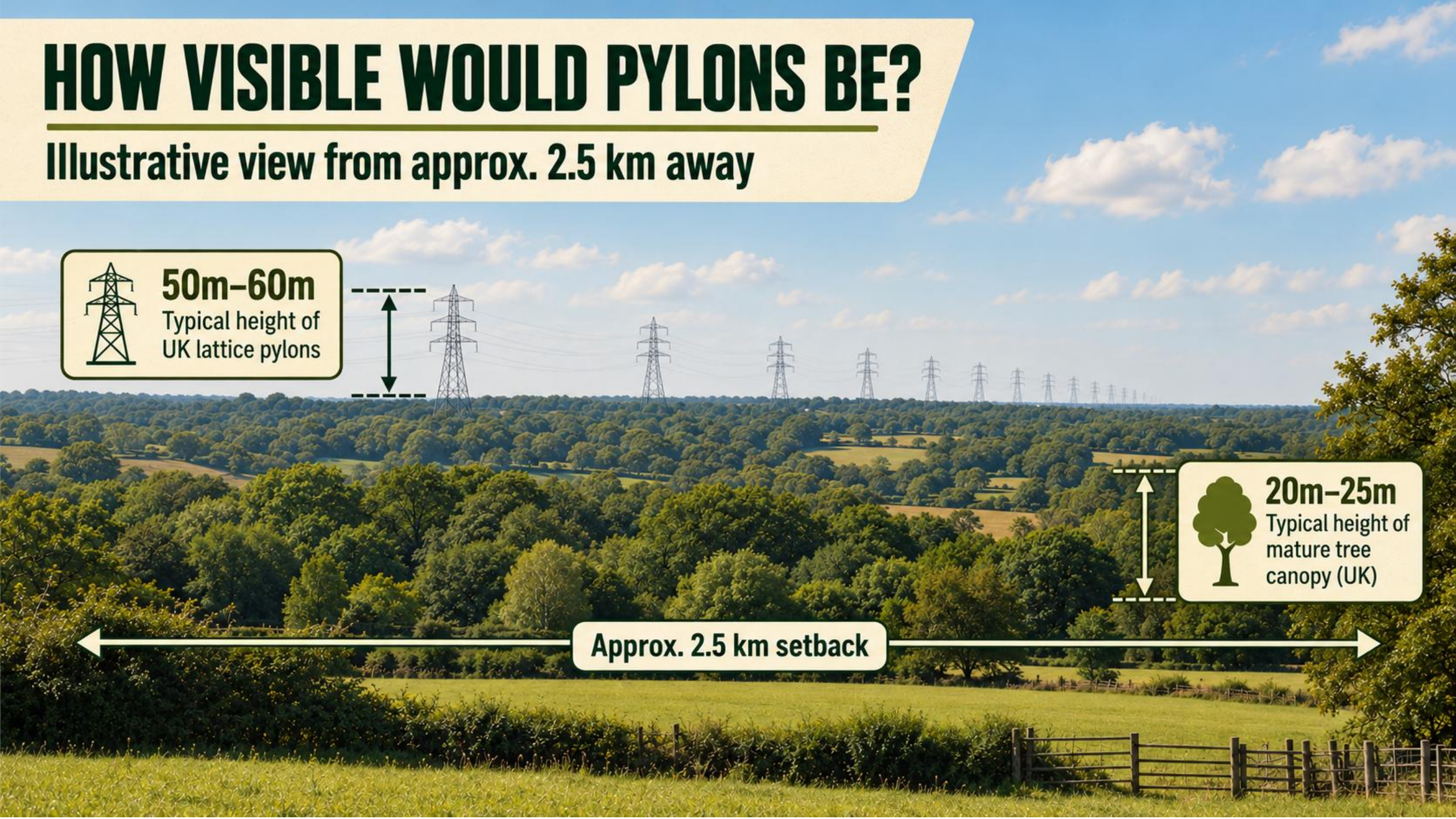
Successive surveys, land access, haul roads, construction traffic, pylon works and substation development could affect communities well into the 2030s.

NOT ONE PROJECT. A PIPELINE OF MAJOR GRID WORKS.

Strategic projects and descriptions are based on NESO Beyond 2030 material. Detailed routes and designs remain subject to development, consultation and consent.

HOW VISIBLE WOULD PYLONS BE?

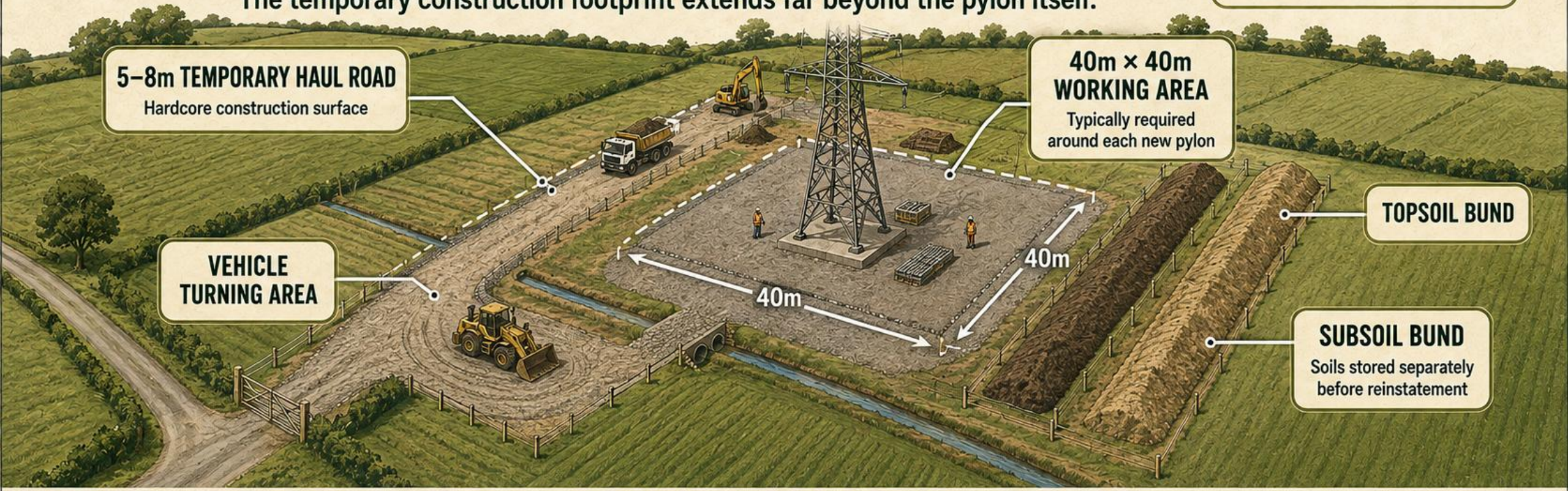
Illustrative view from approx. 2.5 km away



CONSTRUCTION ACCESS & LAND TAKE

3–5 YEARS
Potential construction period

The temporary construction footprint extends far beyond the pylon itself.



ACCESS DISRUPTION
Temporary routes can interrupt normal farm access.

DRAINAGE RISK
Compaction and crossings can affect field drainage.

CROP YIELD
Working areas remove productive land during construction.

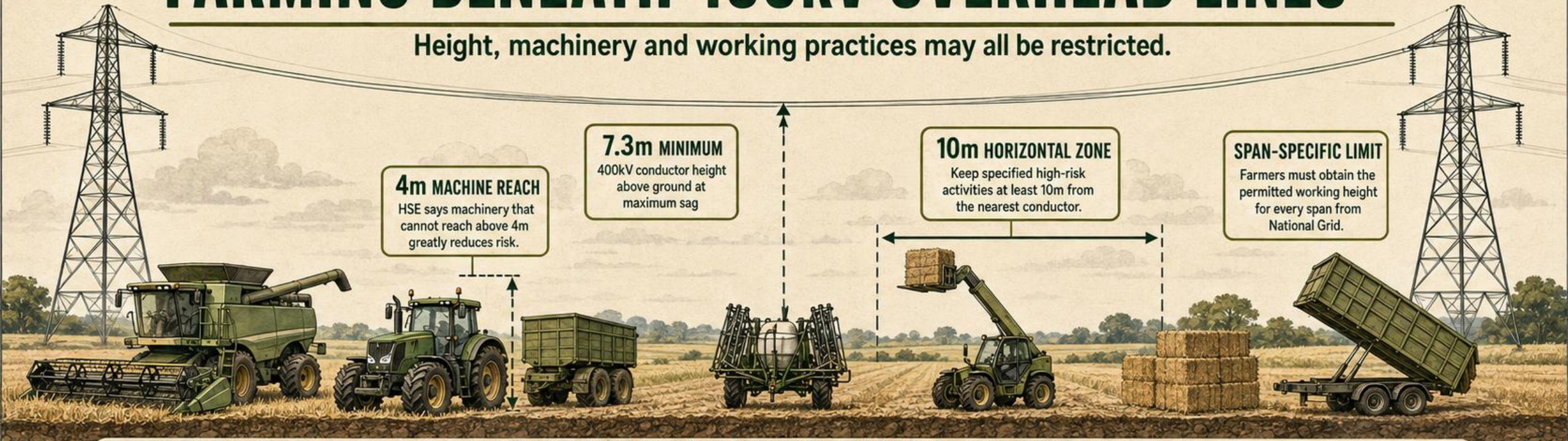
SOIL DEGRADATION
Handling and compaction can reduce soil quality.

THE PYLON IS ONLY PART OF THE FOOTPRINT.

Indicative construction arrangement. Exact requirements would depend on final design, ground conditions and contractor methodology.

FARMING BENEATH 400kV OVERHEAD LINES

Height, machinery and working practices may all be restricted.



4m MACHINE REACH
HSE says machinery that cannot reach above 4m greatly reduces risk.

7.3m MINIMUM
400kV conductor height above ground at maximum sag

10m HORIZONTAL ZONE
Keep specified high-risk activities at least 10m from the nearest conductor.

SPAN-SPECIFIC LIMIT
Farmers must obtain the permitted working height for every span from National Grid.

WORK THAT MAY NEED TO MOVE OR CHANGE


Tipping trailers


Stacking bales


Folding sprayer booms


Using telehandlers


Working on top of machinery


Moving ladders or irrigation pipes

WHAT NATIONAL GRID SAYS

Those carrying out the work must assess the risk, prepare a safe system and ensure it is followed.

National Grid provides line profiles and advice — but says it will not approve working methods.

THE IMPACT ON FARMERS

New infrastructure creates a permanent operational and safety burden for farmers, workers and contractors.

THE LINE REMAINS. THE RESTRICTIONS REMAIN.

Network operators retain duties for safe design, operation and statutory clearances. Exact limits require site-specific advice. Sources: HSE AIS8, HSE GS6 and National Grid third-party guidance.

WHAT DO THE PYLONS MEAN FOR HETHERSGILL & SURROUNDING AREA?

CONSTRUCTION PHASE (APPROXIMATELY 3 – 5 YEARS)

LARGE SCALE, DISRUPTIVE WORKS ACROSS OUR COMMUNITIES

KEY CONSTRUCTION IMPACTS

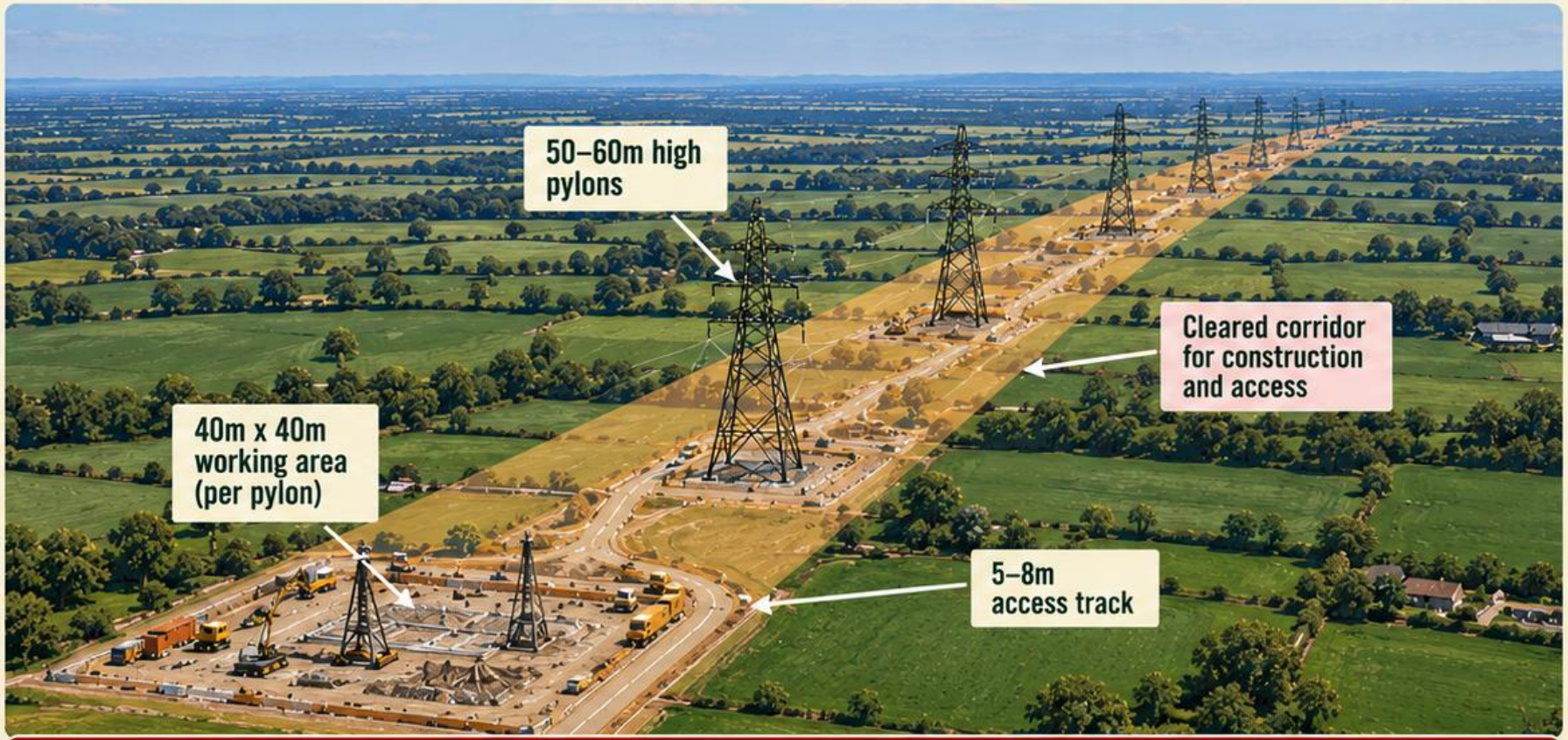
LARGE CONSTRUCTION SITES
Wide working areas (typically 40m × 40m per pylon), temporary compounds, equipment storage and welfare facilities across the route.

INCREASED HEAVY TRAFFIC
Movement of large plant, materials and abnormal loads using new and upgraded haul roads (5–8m wide), causing congestion, noise, dust and safety risks on local roads.

LAND TAKE AND ACCESS ROADS
Temporary and permanent land take for working areas, access tracks and construction compounds, impacting farmland, field boundaries, hedgerows and drainage.

NOISE, DUST AND LIGHTING
Piling foundations (up to 22m deep), 24/7 working at times, construction noise, dust, lighting and vibration affecting nearby homes, farms and wildlife.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISTURBANCE
Disruption to habitats, hedge and tree removal, impacts on protected sites, watercourses, soils and peat.



THIS IS THE SCALE AND TYPE OF CONSTRUCTION ACTIVITY OUR COMMUNITIES WILL EXPERIENCE DURING THE CONSTRUCTION PHASE.

OUR LANDSCAPE. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE.

THE HOLFORD RULES

A NATIONAL PLANNING TEST FOR PYLON ROUTES

AVOID HARM WHERE POSSIBLE
IT'S A NATIONAL REQUIREMENT

National Grid must design overhead line routes to avoid harm to communities, landscape and the environment, as set out in the Holford Rules and the EN-5 National Policy Statement.

1 AVOID HIGH VALUE AREAS

Major areas of high landscape, amenity, heritage or scientific value should be avoided where possible, even if this means a longer route.



2 DEVIATE AROUND SENSITIVE AREAS

Route around, rather than through, smaller areas of value, such as wildlife habitats, heritage assets or established communities.



3 REDUCE VISUAL IMPACT

Use landform and tree cover to minimise visibility and avoid unnecessary "wirescape" in the landscape.



4 CONSIDER UNDERGROUNDING OR ALTERNATIVE ROUTES

Particularly where sensitive residential or recreational areas are affected, consider undergrounding or a re-routed alignment.



LANDSCAPE CHARACTER ASSESSMENT (LCA) MATTERS

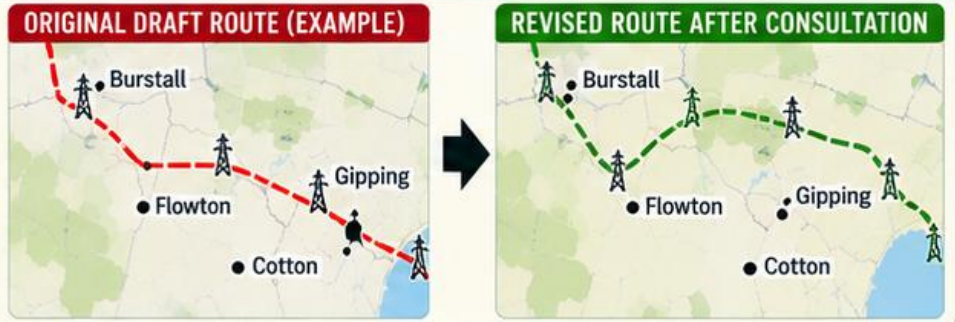
The Landscape Character Assessment (LCA) is a key evidence base used to identify the sensitivity and value of different landscape areas. The Holford Rules require routes to avoid, where possible, areas of highest landscape value and to have regard to landscape character and its sensitivity to overhead lines.

Option A passes through LCA areas identified as sensitive lowland farmland with valued landscape, heritage, biodiversity and recreation assets.

REAL EXAMPLE: NORWICH TO TILBURY (EAST ANGLIA)

Following non-statutory consultation, National Grid made several changes to the draft alignment to move the route away from communities including Burstall, Cotton, Flowton and Gipping, applying the Holford Rules in developing the revised route.

The route was adjusted to reduce landscape and community impacts.



THE HOLFORD RULES ARE NOT OPTIONAL

Under EN-5, the Secretary of State must be satisfied that National Grid has complied with the Holford Rules, so far as reasonably possible.

LOW-FLYING AIRCRAFT & AVIATION SAFEGUARDING

WHY THIS IS A MATERIAL CONSIDERATION FOR THE CROSS BORDER CONNECTION

WHY IT MATTERS

LOW-FLYING TRAINING

UK energy policy recognises that military low flying occurs across the UK, with tactical training in Cumbria and the Scottish Border region at very low altitude.

PHYSICAL OBSTACLES

50–60m pylons, conductors, substation structures and construction cranes can require assessment as potential obstructions in low-flying areas.

RADAR & COMMUNICATIONS

Major infrastructure can also require safeguarding assessment for defence radar, technical sites and communications links.

SEARCH & RESCUE

Helicopter operations may involve low-level flying, emergency routing, landing and winching activity that should be considered where relevant.



THE POINT IS NOT TO ASSUME AN IMPACT — IT IS TO ENSURE THE RIGHT AVIATION AND DEFENCE BODIES ASSESS IT EARLY.

AGENCIES / DEPARTMENTS CONTACTED

MOD / DEFENCE INFRASTRUCTURE ORGANISATION SAFEGUARDING

Asked to assess pylons, conductors, substation structures and cranes for defence safeguarding, low flying and other operational interests.

MOD LOW FLYING ENQUIRIES / RAF

Asked to identify relevant low-flying activity, training use and whether proposed obstacles require operational assessment.

CARLISLE AIRPORT OPERATIONS

Asked about local aviation safeguarding, circuits, helicopter activity and operational interactions around the airport.

MARITIME & COASTGUARD AGENCY / HM COASTGUARD SAR

Asked to consider Search & Rescue helicopter operations from Carlisle, including emergency access, low-level searches, landing and winching activity.

For an NSIP, aviation and defence safeguarding evidence can influence route design, tower positioning, construction methodology and mitigation.

OUR LANDSCAPE. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE.

Beyond 2033 – what next?

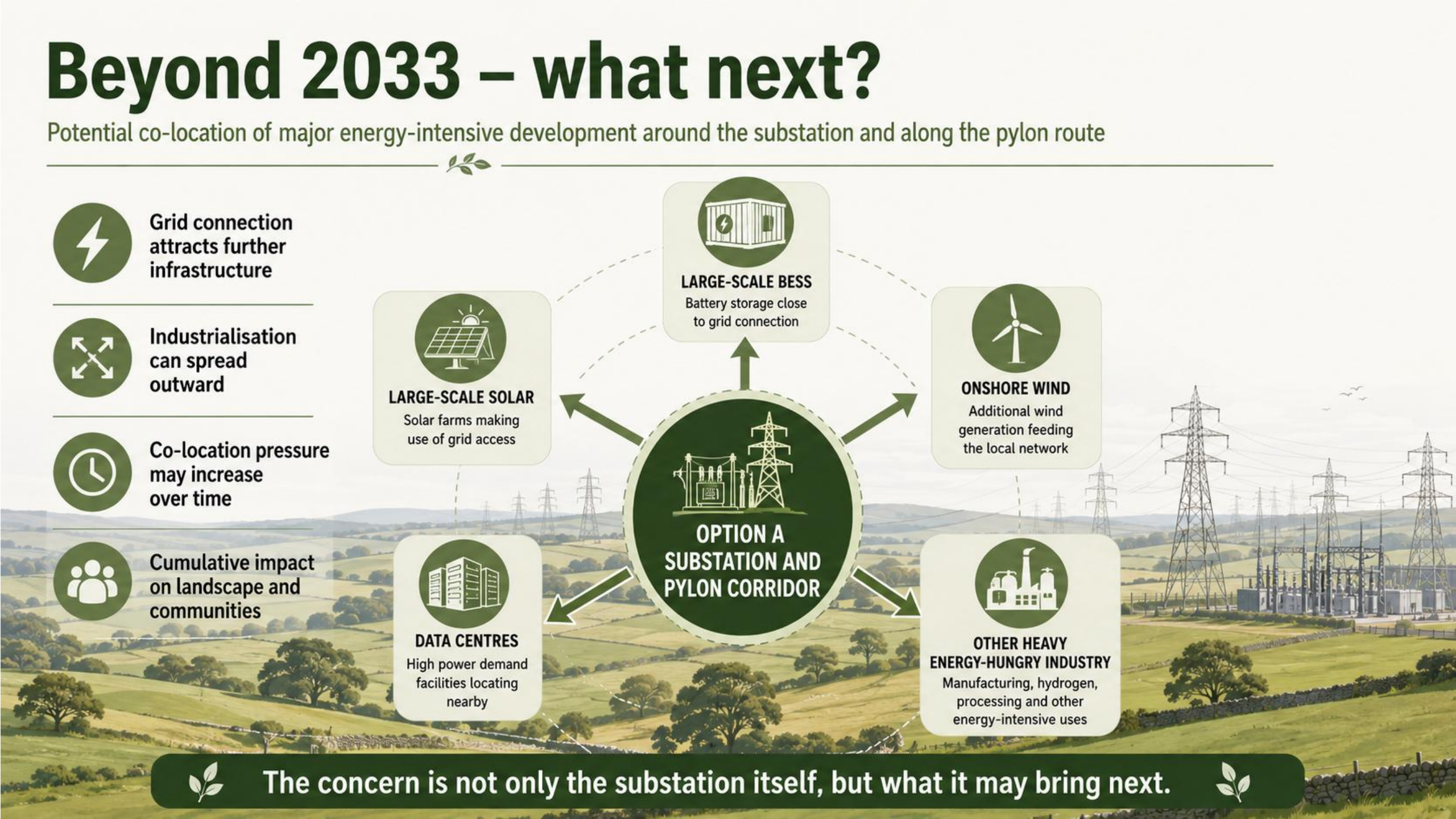
Potential co-location of major energy-intensive development around the substation and along the pylon route

Grid connection attracts further infrastructure

Industrialisation can spread outward

Co-location pressure may increase over time

Cumulative impact on landscape and communities



The concern is not only the substation itself, but what it may bring next.







"A substation located to the south of Carlisle would facilitate the connection of the Proposed Development and other regional reinforcement projects identified by the Beyond 2030 report. Therefore, to facilitate the delivery of the wider regional network capacity, the options selection process also identified an emerging preference for a route corridor and substation option to the south of Carlisle. This is referred to in this CPRSS as Option B."

PROPERTY BLIGHT
THE FINANCIAL RISK SITS WITH HOMEOWNERS

The market can react before any route is consented.

HOW CLOSE?

NO FIXED UK MINIMUM RESIDENTIAL SETBACK

Electrical clearances and case-specific planning tests apply.

WHAT UK EVIDENCE SHOWS

6–17% — Reduction within 100 metres in one UK case study.

5–10% — Typical reduction perceived by valuers and estate agents.



Indicative evidence only — local effects require independent valuation.

NO AUTOMATIC COMPENSATION

1. **LAND OR RIGHTS ACQUIRED**
   Compensation may apply where land or permanent rights are taken.
2. **STATUTORY BLIGHT**
   Only qualifying owners on specific legal grounds may compel purchase.
3. **NO LAND TAKEN**
   Loss of view or nearby market impact is not automatically compensable.
4. **BILL DISCOUNT**
   Community benefit is not compensation for lost capital value.

BEFORE OPTION A IS SELECTED, REQUIRE:

- Baseline valuations
- Property impact assessment
- Voluntary support scheme
- Funded professional advice

THE PROJECT SHOULD CARRY THE COST — NOT THE HOMEOWNER

North Carlisle/Cumbria
Against Pylons and Substation

WHAT NATIONAL GRID WILL BE DOING NOW

NATIONAL GRID CROSS BORDER CONNECTION

CURRENT PROGRAMME (UPDATED 2025)

SUMMER 2025
Ongoing route and site optioneering and environmental studies.

2026
Continued surveys, technical assessments and stakeholder engagement.

2027 (Q2 – MOST LIKELY)
Stage 2 Consultation – publication of preferred route and substation options.

2027 – 2028
Development Consent Order (DCO) application preparation and submission to Planning Inspectorate.

2028 – 2030
Examination of DCO by Planning Inspectorate and recommendation to Secretary of State.

2030 (EARLIEST)
Secretary of State decision on DCO and start of build (subject to conditions).

Timings are indicative and subject to change.
Final decisions rest with the Secretary of State.

WORKING TOGETHER | RAISING OUR VOICES | PROTECTING OUR COMMUNITIES | BUILDING A STRONG LOCAL RESPONSE

NORTH CARLISLE/CUMBRIA
AGAINST PYLONS & SUBSTATION

NSIP CONSULTEES & INFLUENCE BODIES

Who can shape, challenge or decide the Cross Border Connection?

HIGHER FORMAL INFLUENCE

WIDER LOCAL PRESSURE

1 DECISION-MAKERS

- **Secretary of State** — Makes the final decision.
- **Planning Inspectorate / Examining Authority** — Tests the evidence and makes a recommendation.

2 KEY AUTHORITIES

- **Cumberland Council** — Host authority.
- **Cumbria Combined Authority** — Strategic transport, growth and regional leadership.

3 STATUTORY CONSULTEES

- **Natural England** — Nature and environment.
- **Environment Agency** — Flood risk and water environment.
- **Historic England** — Heritage assets.
- **National Highways** — Strategic roads and access.
- **Ministry of Defence** — Defence interests.

4 LOCAL EVIDENCE & PRESSURE

- **Parish Councils** — Local views.
- **Residents & Community Groups** — Community evidence.
- **Landowners & Farmers** — Land use and local impacts.
- **Local MPs** — Political pressure and representations.

WHY CUMBERLAND COUNCIL MATTERS

- Its Local Impact Report must be considered.
- Its view helps test the adequacy of consultation.
- It can record unresolved impacts and shape requirements.

Indicative practical influence — not a statutory hierarchy. Weight depends on each body's role and the evidence before the examination.

COMMUNITY INFLUENCE OPPORTUNITY

How councils, the combined authority and the community can help challenge Option A

CORE ASK: Tell National Grid that Option A is the wrong site

1. Cumberland Council

- Formal consultation response
- Local Impact Report
- Planning, highways and public health evidence

2. Combined Authority

- Regional political leadership
- Strategic voice with government and agencies
- Support for a stronger alternative

3. Community action

- Write early
- Submit evidence
- Coordinate messages
- Press for alternatives
- Carry the case into NSIP

Intended outcome

- Option A lacks local support
- The planning record is clear
- Alternatives are pushed harder
- Community concerns are amplified

OPTION A IS THE WRONG SITE

AREAS OF FOCUS

KEY PRIORITIES TO CHALLENGE OPTION A AND STRENGTHEN COMMUNITY ACTION

1 POLITICAL LOBBYING



Make this a visible issue locally and nationally.

Secure public commitments from MPs, councillors and political leaders to reject Option A and support a better alternative.

2 HERITAGE SIGNIFICANCE



Protect our unique heritage.

Our area contains nationally and locally significant heritage, including Bronze Age torcs and other archaeological features. Preserve the historic character and setting.

3 PLANNING EXPERTISE



Challenge the plans with expert advice.

Instruct independent planning specialists to assess the scheme, identify flaws and ensure the true impacts on our area are fully represented.

4 ECOLOGICAL IMPACTS



Protect our environment and wildlife.

Assess impacts on protected species, habitats, peat soils, watercourses and designated sites with specialist ecological experts.

5 COMMUNITY IMPACTS



Ensure our communities are heard.

Understand and evidence the impact on homes, farms, businesses, tranquillity, health and wellbeing during construction and for generations to come.

6 PUBLIC HEALTH IMPACTS



Understand and evidence the risks.

Investigate potential health impacts from noise, visual intrusion, electromagnetic fields, dust and construction activity, and ensure they are not dismissed or overlooked.

7 BUILD ALLIANCES



Work together for a stronger voice.

Build alliances with neighbouring communities, parish councils, farmers, businesses and like-minded groups across North Cumbria to strengthen our influence.

8 COORDINATED PRESSURE



Keep the pressure on.

Bring together lobbying, evidence, media, public events and legal challenge in a coordinated campaign to ensure decision-makers understand the strength of local opposition to Option A.

OUR LANDSCAPE. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE.


HOWBERRY 1
KIRKLINTON 3
BLACKFORD 1½
CARLISLE 5½

HOW YOU CAN HELP

SIX PRACTICAL ACTIONS TO PROTECT HETHERSGILL & SURROUUNDING AREA

1 JOIN NCAPS



Be part of a stronger voice.

Follow our Facebook page, join our WhatsApp community and sign up for campaign updates.

northcarlisleaps@gmail.com

2 ATTEND & BE HEARD



Make your voice count.

Join community meetings, public demonstrations and council sessions. Visible local support helps ensure Hethersgill and surrounding area's concerns cannot be ignored.

3 SIGN & SHARE



Add your name and spread the word.

Sign the petition rejecting Option A and ask family, friends and neighbours to do the same.

4 SUPPORT PLANNING EXPERTISE



Help us challenge the plans.

We are instructing independent planning specialists to assess the scheme, identify flaws and ensure the true impacts on our area are fully represented.

5 SECURE ECOLOGY EXPERTISE



Protect our environment and heritage.

We are seeking specialist ecology evidence to assess impacts on protected species, habitats, peat soils, watercourses and designated sites, including our unique heritage such as Bronze Age torcs.

6 HELP FUND OUR EXPERTS



Help us instruct independent experts.

We are raising funds to instruct planning, ecology, landscape, legal and technical experts to properly challenge the proposals at the DCO examination.

c.£47,500
ALREADY CONTRIBUTED

Thanks to the incredible support from our community, we have already raised c.£47,500.

ADDITIONAL £250,000+
REQUIRED TO COMPLETE OUR CAMPAIGN

We now need to raise a further £250,000+ to fund additional expert support and continue our challenge through the DCO examination.

North Carlisle/Cumbria
Against Pylons and Substation

OUR LANDSCAPE. OUR COMMUNITY. OUR FUTURE.

Thank You

Questions?

Thank you for your time, support and interest.

We welcome your questions and comments.

